combating terrorism, deepening ties with Russia, and strengthening India's engagement in Central Asia.

Leading up to the Wuhan Summit in April 2018 and the SCO Summit in Qingdao in June 2018, the first for India as a full member of the SCO, India made some accommodating adjustments towards China. These efforts, however, should be interpreted as part of a joint India–China effort to reset relations after the 2017 Doklam crisis and not indicative of long-term changes in India's policy on China.[5]

Nevertheless, despite the growing number of meeting places and organisations facilitating an active diplomacy between India and China, India is also engaged in a "diplomatic battle" of sorts with China in several countries in South Asia, as well as in Iran. According to Muni, India has for the past couple of years undertaken a Neighbourhood First 2.0 policy recast, with greater emphasis on countering China's influence in the region. India has added momentum to its development cooperation and taken efforts to improve efficiency and implementation of promised projects, and India has extended its collaboration with extra-regional strategic partners like Japan and the United States to meet the Chinese financial and performance challenge in its neighbourhood. Furthermore, it has put on the back burner earlier muscular diplomacy and unilateral assertion of India's own goals in order to bridge the alienation gap at the highest political levels in neighbouring countries, and India is now trying to cajole and cultivate regimes in the neighbourhood. An important aspect of this, as outlined in the chapter by Xavier, is through reinforcing the use of soft power and cultural diplomacy. Still, several contributors to this volume express concern about the effectiveness and success of some of India's efforts in its neighbourhood, illustrating that an intention of balancing is of no avail unless it is implemented and supported by sufficient resources to make a difference.